

tirement does allow mom and dad more time together and more time with the kids. For those who feel their job is keeping them from enjoying their family, retirement makes sense.

Some tireless parents seem to divide their attention between the office and home. Chambers Tate, the consultant from chapter 8, works every other week. That way he can spend his off-week with his kids. Another friend has an infant son. Three days a week she works at home, writing magazine articles, while a baby-sitter takes care of the baby in another part of the house. Another friend runs his own business but refuses to expand and take on employees. He believes people problems exhaust one's energy. He'd rather have time and energy for himself and his family than the prestige, power, and money an expanded business would bring.

But who can afford to work half-time, write three days a week, or refuse to expand? As we rise through the ranks, most of us have to devote more time to our jobs, not less. But does that make sense? If you can afford to retire, wouldn't your family be better off with a full-time mom and dad?

DO WHAT YOU WANT

The third part of the three-part formula for very early retirement is, "Do what you want." Like the first two parts, what you do in retirement changes when you have kids. Those of us without kids travel off-season rather than during summer vacation. We take tours of France's wine country without having to worry about boring the kids. We wander around Mayan ruins in Mexico's Yucatán peninsula without having to worry about the children contracting a rare disease.

But when you have kids, your to-do list changes. Instead of only the things you want to do, your to-do list includes the things your kids might want to do as well. After all, you retired to spend more time with your kids and have a richer